

Guidelines for BDI-II Annotation Study

Hello, and thank you for participating in our study.

Purpose of the study: This study involves interaction with a generative AI chatbot that simulates depressive symptoms. The aim of the study is to talk with a chatbot of a simulated patient, and fill the BDI-II test for this patient based on the conversation with them. The task is intended for participants with professional training or experience in psychology, clinical psychology, psychiatry, counseling, etc. We conduct this study to help improve depression detection systems, and to have examples of how to appropriately approach and handle conversations involving depressive topics and individuals. The final product of this study will be a *publicly accessible, anonymized data collection* consisting of a conversation between a chatbot patient and a trained professional, with BDI-II symptom annotation information for each turn of the conversation.

PLEASE TALK TO THE SIMULATED PATIENT AS YOU WOULD WITH A REAL PATIENT.

The patient is entirely fake, and is simulated by a generative AI model. The patient does not mimic any individual or situation in real life, and any resemblance to real persons, living or dead, or to any events, is purely coincidental.

The AI model is trained and instructed to simulate a patient with possible depressive symptoms, which can result in mentions of sensitive topics such as suicide.

The entire data collected will be the following. The titles put in bold will be included in the final public dataset.

- **session_id**: alphanumeric code identifying the session opened to talk to the chatbot
- **prolific_id**: Prolific ID of the participant for payment purposes
- **patient_id**: ID of chatbot patient
- **participant_id**: non-identifying random ID assigned to participant by the organizers
- **start_time**: starting time of the session in format YYYY-MM-DDTHH:MM:SS
- **end_time**: ending time of the session in format YYYY-MM-DDTHH:MM:SS
- **messages**:
 - **role**: Either participant or chatbot
 - **content**: Text provided by the participant or chatbot
- **turn_annotations**:
 - **turn**: corresponding turn number
 - **symptoms**: list of BDI-II symptoms that are inferred from the turn
 - **scores**: scores of the chosen BDI-II symptoms
 - **annotated_at**: annotation time in format YYYY-MM-DDTHH:MM:SS

What you will do in the study:

You will be provided with 2 separate links in order to:

1. Access the BDI-II test text
2. Talk to the chatbot